

“ WE’VE HAD A TERRIBLE VOYAGE... THE WONDER IS WE ARE HERE AT ALL. ”

John Alcock, officer in the British RAF, after flying nonstop across the Atlantic, June 15, 1919



John Alcock and Arthur Whitten Brown in the plane they flew on the first nonstop transatlantic flight from Newfoundland in Canada to Ireland.

Red and White armies was vicious, and accompanied by massacres and atrocities on a vast scale.

In the midst of this mayhem, Russia hosted a congress in Moscow to found the **Third International**, known as Comintern. Its aim was to promote the spread of communist revolution worldwide; its effect was to split the international socialist movement, forcing people on the political left to choose between social democracy and revolutionary communism.



The vision of an imminent world revolution had some credibility at a time when radical workers' and anti-colonial movements were challenging the established authority in many countries.

Outside Russia, it was only in **Hungary** that **communists** established a national government in 1919. The collapse of the Austro-Hungarian Empire was a disaster for Hungary, which faced the loss of two-thirds of its prewar territory to Czechoslovakia, Romania, and Yugoslavia. The communist **Bela Kun** (1886–1938) took power in March, launching military offensives against Czechoslovakia and Romania. He followed the Bolshevik example by forming a Red Army and exercising a reign of terror against his opponents, but after 133 days in power he was defeated by the Romanians. Admiral Miklós Horthy's counter-revolutionary National Army marched into Budapest to suppress the communists with another reign of terror. In 1920, Horthy took power in Hungary as "Regent."

In **Italy**, people of all political persuasions were disgusted with their country's limited share in the spoils of victory. Orlando was forced to resign as prime minister on his return from the Paris Peace



Italians enter Fiume
Gabriele D'Annunzio's nationalist legionnaires salute the flag of the short-lived Regency of Carnaro in Fiume, now the Croatian city of Rijeka.

garden in Amritsar, Punjab. At least 379 people were killed. Although the British government condemned the killings and dismissed

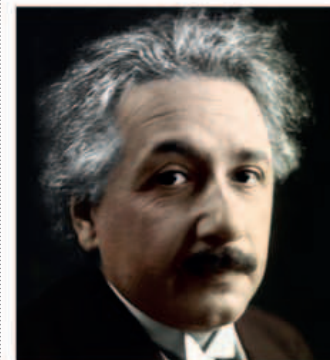
General Dyer, the **Amritsar massacre** caused widespread outrage in India and increased pressure for independence. Despite the world's troubles, technological and scientific progress continued. On June 14, British pilot Captain John Alcock (1892–1919) and his navigator Lieutenant Arthur Whitten Brown (1886–1948) took off from St. John's, Newfoundland, to attempt the **first nonstop flight across the Atlantic**. After a perilous 16 hours 27 minutes, their Vickers Vimy bomber aircraft landed nose-down in a bog in Galway, Ireland. Their feat won them a hero's welcome in London, but Alcock's triumph was short-lived, as he was killed in an air crash just six months later.

At the time when Alcock and Brown made their famous flight, British scientists were analyzing the results of an expedition sent to the African island of Principe to observe a solar eclipse. The

Meanwhile, **Britain was facing opposition to its rule in India**. The British were committed to a promise made during World War I to grant the Indians a measure of self-government, but they suspended civil liberties in a crackdown on what were described as "anarchical and revolutionary crimes." On April 13, British officer General Reginald Dyer (1864–1927) ordered troops to fire on an unarmed crowd of protestors at the Jallianwalla Bagh, a public

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expedition was intended to test the validity of the **General Theory of Relativity**, a revolutionary concept in physics formulated during World War I by Albert Einstein (1879–1955). In September it was announced that the observations did indeed confirm Einstein's theory, fundamentally changing the notions of time and space that had underpinned Isaac Newton's view of the universe.



ALBERT EINSTEIN
(1879–1955)

Einstein was born to Jewish parents in southern Germany. In 1905, he published his Special Theory of Relativity, which was followed by the General Theory of Relativity in 1915. His theories revolutionized understanding of the relationship between time, space, matter, and energy. From the 1920s Einstein was fêted worldwide, but chose exile in the US, away from Hitler's Germany.

